专八精读

TEM-8 · READING · SECTION A

镇上形影不离的两个哑巴

英语专业八级 2021年 · *Passage Two*

记叙文 · 人物与友谊

全文 1246 词 · 逐句精读

● 单词 ■ 短语

In the town there were two **mutes**[1], and they were always **together**[2].

镇上有两个哑巴，他们总是形影不离。

VOCABULARY

1. **mute** *n.* 哑巴；哑人
2. **together** *adv.* 一起；在一块儿

Early every morning they would come out from[1] the house where they lived and walk arm in arm[2] down the street to work.

每天一大早，他们都会从住处出来，手挽着手沿街走去上班。

VOCABULARY

1 come out from 从……出来

2 arm in arm 手挽着手

The one who always steered[1] the way was an obese[2] and dreamy[3] Greek[4].

总在前面领路的那个，是个肥胖而迷迷糊糊的希腊人。

VOCABULARY

1. steer *v.* 引导；带（路）
2. obese *adj.* 肥胖的
3. dreamy *adj.* 迷迷糊糊的；恍惚的
4. Greek *n.* 希腊人

In the summer he would come out[1] wearing a yellow or green polo shirt[2] ...

夏天，他出门时会穿一件黄色或绿色的马球衫，

VOCABULARY

1 come out 出来；出门

2 polo shirt 马球衫；Polo衫

… stuffed[3] sloppily[4] into his trousers[5] in front[6] and hanging loose[7] behind.

前面胡乱塞在裤子里，后面松松垮垮地耷拉着。

VOCABULARY

3 **stuff** *v.* 塞；填

4 **sloppily** *adv.* 马虎地；邋遢地

5 **trousers** *n.* 裤子

6 **in front** 在前面

7 **hang loose** 松垂；松散地耷拉着

When it was colder, he wore over[1] this a shapeless[2] gray[3] sweater[4].

天冷一些的时候，他就在外面套一件走了样的灰毛衣。

VOCABULARY

1. over *prep.* 罩在……外面
2. shapeless *adj.* 不成形的；走了样的
3. gray *adj.* 灰色的
4. sweater *n.* 毛衣

His face was round and oily[1], with half-closed[2] eyelids[3] and lips[4] that curved[5] in a gentle[6], stupid[7] smile.

他的脸圆圆的，油光光的，眼皮半闭着，嘴唇弯出一抹温和而傻乎乎的笑。

VOCABULARY

1. **oily** *adj.* 油光光的；油腻的
2. **half-closed** *adj.* 半闭的
3. **eyelid** *n.* 眼皮；眼睑
4. **lip** *n.* 嘴唇
5. **curve** *v.* 弯曲；呈弧形
6. **gentle** *adj.* 温和的
7. **stupid** *adj.* 傻的；愚笨的

The other mute[1] was tall.

另一个哑巴个子很高。

VOCABULARY

1 mute *n.* 哑巴；哑人

His eyes had a quick[1], intelligent[2] expression[3].

> 他的眼睛透着机敏、聪慧的神情。

VOCABULARY

1. **quick** *adj.* 机敏的；敏捷的
2. **intelligent** *adj.* 聪明的；有才智的
3. **expression** *n.* 神情；表情

He was always immaculate[1] and very soberly[2] dressed[3].

他总是收拾得一尘不染，穿着十分素净。

VOCABULARY

1. **immaculate** *adj.* 一尘不染的；整洁的
2. **soberly** *adv.* 素净地；朴素地
3. **dressed** *adj.* 穿……衣服的

Every morning the two friends walked silently[1] together until they reached[2] the main street[3] of the town.

每天早上，这两个朋友都默默地一起走，一直走到镇上的大街。

VOCABULARY

1. **silently** *adv.* 默默地；静静地
2. **reach** *v.* 到达
3. **main street** 大街；主街

Then when they came to[1] a certain[2] fruit and candy[3] store, they paused[4] for a moment[5] on the sidewalk[6] outside.

> 接着，来到某家水果糖果店时，他们会在店外的人行道上停一会儿。

VOCABULARY

1. **come to** 来到；到达
2. **certain** *adj.* 某个；某一
3. **candy** *n.* 糖果
4. **pause** *v.* 停顿；暂停
5. **for a moment** 片刻；一会儿
6. **sidewalk** *n.* 人行道

The Greek[1], Spiros Antonapoulos, worked for[2] his cousin[3], who owned[4] this fruit store.

那个希腊人叫斯皮罗斯·安东尼帕罗斯，在他表兄手下干活，这家水果店就是表兄开的。

VOCABULARY

1. Greek *n.* 希腊人
2. work for 为……工作；受雇于
3. cousin *n.* 表（堂）兄弟
4. own *v.* 拥有

His job was to make candies[1] and sweets[2], uncrate[3] the fruits, and keep the place clean[4].

他的活儿是做糖果和甜食，把水果从板条箱里取出来，还要保持店里干净。

VOCABULARY

1. candy *n.* 糖果
2. sweet *n.* 甜食；糖果
3. uncrate *v.* 从板条箱中取出
4. keep...clean 使……保持干净

The thin mute[1], John Singer, nearly always put his hand on his friend's arm and looked for a second[3] into his face[2] before leaving him.

那个瘦哑巴叫约翰·辛格，分开之前，
他几乎每次都把手搭在朋友的胳膊上，
注视他的脸片刻。

VOCABULARY

1. mute *n.* 哑巴；哑人
2. look into sb's face 注视某人的脸
3. for a second 片刻；一会儿

Then after this goodbye[1] Singer crossed[2] the street and walked on[3] alone[4] to the jewelry[5] store where he worked as[6] a silverware[7] engraver[8].

这样道别之后，辛格便穿过马路，独自继续往前走，一直走到那家珠宝店，他在那里当银器雕刻工。

VOCABULARY

1. goodbye *n.* 告别；道别
2. cross *v.* 穿过；横穿
3. walk on 继续往前走
4. alone *adv.* 独自
5. jewelry *n.* 珠宝；首饰
6. work as 担任；当
7. silverware *n.* 银器
8. engraver *n.* 雕刻工；雕刻师

In the late afternoon[1] the friends would meet again.

傍晚时分，两个朋友又会碰面。

VOCABULARY

1 late afternoon 傍晚；下午晚些时候

Singer came back to[1] the fruit store and waited until Antonapoulos was ready to[2] go home.

辛格回到水果店，一直等到安东尼帕罗斯准备好回家。

VOCABULARY

1 come back to 回到

2 be ready to
准备好（做某事）

The Greek would be lazily[1] unpacking[2] a case[3] of peaches[4] or melons[5], or perhaps looking at the funny paper[6] in the kitchen[7] behind the store where he cooked.

这时，那个希腊人往往正懒洋洋地拆一箱桃子或甜瓜，也可能正在店后面他做饭的厨房里看报上的连环漫画。

VOCABULARY

1. lazily *adv.* 懒洋洋地
2. unpack *v.* 打开（箱子）取出东西
3. case *n.* 箱；盒
4. peach *n.* 桃子
5. melon *n.* 瓜；甜瓜
6. funny paper （报纸的）连环漫画版
7. kitchen *n.* 厨房

Before their departure[1] Antonapoulos always opened a paper sack[2] he kept hidden[3] during the day[4] on one of the kitchen[5] shelves[6].

临走前，安东尼帕罗斯总要打开一个纸袋，白天他一直把它藏在厨房的一层架子上。

VOCABULARY

1. departure *n.* 离开；启程
2. sack *n.* 袋子
3. keep sth hidden 把某物藏起来
4. during the day 在白天
5. kitchen *n.* 厨房
6. shelf *n.* 架子；搁板

Inside were stored[1] various[2] bits[3] of food he had collected[4]—a piece of fruit or samples[5] of candy[6].

袋子里存放着他攒下的各种零碎吃食——一个水果，或几块糖果样品。

VOCABULARY

1. **store** *v.* 存放；储存
2. **various** *adj.* 各种各样的
3. **bit** *n.* 一点儿；小块
4. **collect** *v.* 收集；攒
5. **sample** *n.* 样品；试吃品
6. **candy** *n.* 糖果

Usually[1] before leaving Antonapoulos waddled[2] gently[3] to the glassed[4] case[5] in the front of[6] the store ...

离开前，安东尼帕罗斯通常会轻轻地、一摇一摆地走到店堂前部的玻璃柜跟前，

VOCABULARY

1. **usually** *adv.* 通常
2. **waddle** *v.* 摇摇摆摆地走
3. **gently** *adv.* 轻轻地；缓缓地
4. **glassed** *adj.* 装有玻璃的
5. **case** *n.* （玻璃）柜；陈列柜
6. **in the front of** 在……的前部

... where some meats[7] and cheeses[8] were kept[9].

柜子里放着一些肉和奶酪。

VOCABULARY

7 meat *n.* 肉

8 cheese *n.* 奶酪

9 keep *v.* 存放；保存

He glided[1] open the back of the case[2] and his fat hand groped lovingly[4] for[3] some particular[5] dainty[6] inside which he had wanted.

他轻轻地滑开柜子背面的门，胖手满怀爱意地伸进去摸索，寻找他早就想要的某样精致小吃。

VOCABULARY

1. glide *v.*（使）平稳地滑动
2. case *n.*（玻璃）柜；陈列柜
3. grope for 摸索着找
4. lovingly *adv.* 满怀爱意地；深情地
5. particular *adj.* 特定的；某一
6. dainty *n.* 精致的小吃；美味

Sometimes his cousin[1] who owned[2] the place did not see him.

有时候，开这家店的表兄没看见他。

VOCABULARY

1. **cousin** *n.* 表（堂）兄弟
2. **own** *v.* 拥有

But if he noticed[1] he stared at[2] his cousin[3] with a warning[4] in his tight[5], pale[6] face.

可要是表兄发现了，就会紧盯着
这个表弟，紧绷而苍白的脸上带着警告的
神色。

VOCABULARY

1. notice *v.* 注意到；发现
2. stare at 盯着；凝视
3. cousin *n.* 表（堂）兄弟
4. warning *n.* 警告
5. tight *adj.* 紧绷的
6. pale *adj.* 苍白的

Sadly[1], Antonapoulos would shuffle[2] the morsel[3] from one corner[5] of the case[6] to the other[4].

安东尼帕罗斯就会难过地把那一小块吃的从柜子的这一角挪到另一角。

VOCABULARY

1. **sadly** *adv.* 难过地；悲伤地
2. **shuffle** *v.* 把……挪来挪去
3. **morsel** *n.* （食物的）一小块；一小口
4. **from one...to the other** 从一个……到另一个
5. **corner** *n.* 角落
6. **case** *n.* （玻璃）柜；陈列柜

During these times Singer stood very straight[1] with his hands in his pockets[2] and looked in another direction[3].

每逢这种时候，辛格就把手插在口袋里，站得笔直，眼睛望向别处。

VOCABULARY

1. straight *adv.* 笔直地
2. pocket *n.* 口袋；衣兜
3. direction *n.* 方向

He did not like to watch this little scene[1] between the two Greeks[2].

他不喜欢看两个希腊人之间的这个小场面。

VOCABULARY

1 scene *n.* 场面；情景

2 Greek *n.* 希腊人

For[1], except[2] drinking and a certain[3] solitary[4] secret[5] pleasure[6], Antonapoulos loved to eat more than anything else[7] in the world.

因为，除了喝酒和某种独自享受的隐秘乐趣，安东尼帕罗斯在这世上最爱的就是吃。

VOCABULARY

1. for *conj.* 因为
2. except *prep.* 除了
3. certain *adj.* 某种
4. solitary *adj.* 独自的；孤独的
5. secret *adj.* 秘密的；隐秘的
6. pleasure *n.* 乐趣；享乐
7. more than anything else 胜过其他一切

In the dusk[1] the two mutes[2] walked slowly home together.

暮色中，两个哑巴一起慢慢走回家。

VOCABULARY

1. **dusk** *n.* 黄昏；暮色
2. **mute** *n.* 哑巴；哑人

At home Singer **was always talking**[1] to Antonapoulos.

在家里，辛格总是在跟安东尼帕罗斯说话。

VOCABULARY

1 **be always doing** 总是（老是）在做（表示频繁）

His hands shaped[1] the words in a swift[3] series of[2] designs[4].

他的双手飞快地比画出一连串图形，打出一个个词。

VOCABULARY

1. **shape** *v.* 使成形；比画出
2. **a series of** 一连串；一系列
3. **swift** *adj.* 迅速的；飞快的
4. **design** *n.* 图形；图案

His face was eager[1] and his gray-green[2] eyes sparkled[3] brightly[4].

他满脸热切，一双灰绿色的眼睛闪闪发亮。

VOCABULARY

1. **eager** *adj.* 热切的；急切的
2. **gray-green** *adj.* 灰绿色的
3. **sparkle** *v.* 闪耀；闪闪发光
4. **brightly** *adv.* 明亮地

With his thin[1], strong hands he told Antonapoulos all that had happened during the day[2].

他用那双瘦削有力的手，把白天发生的一切都讲给安东尼帕罗斯听。

VOCABULARY

1 thin *adj.* 瘦削的；细长的

2 during the day 在白天

When back at home, Antonapoulos sat back[1] lazily[2] and looked at Singer.

回到家里，安东尼帕罗斯便懒洋洋地往后一靠，看着辛格。

VOCABULARY

1 **sit back** 向后靠坐

2 **lazily** *adv.* 懒洋洋地

It was seldom[2] that[1] he ever moved his hands to speak at all[3]—and then it was to say that he wanted to eat or to sleep or to drink.

他难得动一动手来说话——即便动了，也只是说他想吃，或者想睡，或者想喝。

VOCABULARY

1 **it is...that** 强调句型（It is/was…that…）

2 **seldom** *adv.* 很少；难得

3 **at all**（加强语气）根本；到底

These three things he always said with the same vague[1], fumbling[2] signs[3].

这三件事，他总是用同样含糊、笨拙的手势来表示。

VOCABULARY

1. **vague** *adj.* 含糊的；模糊的
2. **fumbling** *adj.* 笨拙的；摸索的
3. **sign** *n.* 手势；手语

At night, if he were not too drunk[1], he would kneel down[2] before his bed and pray[3] awhile[4].

夜里，要是醉得不太厉害，他会跪在床前祈祷一会儿。

VOCABULARY

1. drunk *adj.* 喝醉的
2. kneel down 跪下
3. pray *v.* 祈祷
4. awhile *adv.* 片刻；一会儿

Then his plump[1] hands shaped[2] the words Holy[3] Jesus, or God, or Darling[4] Mary.

接着，他那双胖乎乎的手比画出“圣耶稣”，或“上帝”，或“亲爱的玛利亚”。

VOCABULARY

1. **plump** *adj.* 胖乎乎的；丰满的
2. **shape** *v.* 使成形；比画出
3. **holy** *adj.* 神圣的
4. **darling** *adj.* 亲爱的

These were the only words Antonapoulos ever[1] said.

安东尼帕罗斯说过的词，就只有这几个。

VOCABULARY

1 **ever** *adv.* 曾经；（用于强调）从来

Singer never knew
just how much[1] his friend
understood of all the things he
told him.

辛格告诉朋友的种种事情，朋友究竟懂了多少，他从来都不知道。

VOCABULARY

1 just how much
究竟多少

But it did not matter[1].

> 但这并不要紧。

VOCABULARY

1 **matter** *v.* 要紧；有关系

They shared[1] the upstairs[2] of a small house near the business section[3] of the town.

他们合住在镇上商业区附近一座小房子的楼上。

VOCABULARY

1. share *v.* 合用；共享
2. upstairs *n.* 楼上
3. business section 商业区

There were[1] **two rooms.**

楼上共有两个房间。

VOCABULARY

1 **there be** 有；
存在（there be 句型）

On the oil stove[1] in the kitchen[2] Antonapoulos cooked[3] all of their meals[4].

他们的饭全是安东尼帕罗斯在厨房的油炉上做的。

VOCABULARY

1. oil stove 油炉；煤油炉
2. kitchen *n.* 厨房
3. cook *v.* 烹调；做（饭菜）
4. meal *n.* 一餐；饭菜

There were straight[1], plain[2] kitchen[3] chairs for Singer and an overstuffed[4] sofa[5] for Antonapoulos.

屋里给辛格准备的是几把直背的简朴厨房椅，给安东尼帕罗斯准备的是一张塞得鼓鼓囊囊的沙发。

VOCABULARY

1. straight *adj.* 直背的；直的
2. plain *adj.* 简朴的；朴素的
3. kitchen *n.* 厨房
4. overstuffed *adj.* （家具）软垫塞得很厚的
5. sofa *n.* 沙发

The bedroom[1] was furnished mainly[3] with[2] a large double bed[4] ...

卧室里主要摆着一张大双人床和一张窄窄的小铁床：

VOCABULARY

1. bedroom *n.* 卧室
2. be furnished with 配有（家具）
3. mainly *adv.* 主要地
4. double bed 双人床

... covered with[5] an eiderdown[6] comforter[7] for the big Greek[8] and a narrow[9] iron[10] cot[11] for Singer.

双人床铺着鸭绒被，是给那个大块头希腊人睡的；小铁床是给辛格睡的。

VOCABULARY

5 **be covered with** 铺着；覆盖着

6 **eiderdown** *n.* 鸭绒；鸭绒被

7 **comforter** *n.* 被子；盖被

8 **Greek** *n.* 希腊人

9 **narrow** *adj.* 窄的；狭窄的

10 **iron** *adj.* 铁制的

11 **cot** *n.* 行军床；简易床

Dinner[1] **always took a long time**[2], **because Antonapoulos loved food and he was very slow.**

晚饭总要吃很久，因为安东尼帕罗斯爱吃，吃得又非常慢。

VOCABULARY

1 **dinner** *n.* 晚饭；正餐

2 **take a long time**
花很长时间

After they had eaten, the big Greek[1] would lie back[2] on his sofa[3] and slowly lick[4] over each one of his teeth[5] with his tongue[6], ...

吃完饭，那个大块头希腊人会仰靠在沙发上，用舌头慢慢地把每一颗牙齿都舔一遍，

VOCABULARY

1. Greek *n.* 希腊人
2. lie back 往后靠；仰卧
3. sofa *n.* 沙发
4. lick *v.* 舔
5. tooth *n.* 牙齿
6. tongue *n.* 舌头

… either from a certain[8] delicacy[9] or[7] because he did not wish[10] to lose the savor[11] of the meal[12] — while Singer washed the dishes[13].

要么是出于某种讲究，要么是因为不想让饭菜的余味散去；而辛格这时正在洗碗。

VOCABULARY

7 **either...or** 要么……要么

8 **certain** *adj.* 某种

9 **delicacy** *n.* 讲究；（品味上的）精细

10 **wish** *v.* 想要；希望

11 **savor** *n.* 滋味；余味

12 **meal** *n.* 一餐；饭菜

13 **wash the dishes** 洗碗

Sometimes in the evening the mutes[1] would play chess[2].

有时候晚上，两个哑巴会下国际象棋。

VOCABULARY

1 **mute** *n.* 哑巴；哑人

2 **play chess** 下（国际象）棋

Singer had always greatly[1] enjoyed[2] this game, and years before[3] he had tried to teach it to[4] Antonapoulos.

辛格一向非常喜爱这种棋，多年前就曾试着教安东尼帕罗斯下。

VOCABULARY

1. greatly *adv.* 非常；大大地
2. enjoy *v.* 喜爱；享受
3. years before 多年以前
4. teach...to 把……教给

At first[1] his friend could not be interested in[2] the reasons for[3] moving the various[5] pieces[6] about[4] on the board[7].

起初，他的朋友对棋盘上各种棋子为什么要那样挪来挪去，怎么也提不起兴趣。

VOCABULARY

1. **at first** 起初
2. **be interested in** 对……感兴趣
3. **reason for** ……的理由
4. **move...about** 把……挪来挪去
5. **various** *adj.* 各种各样的
6. **piece** *n.* 棋子
7. **board** *n.* 棋盘

Then Singer began to keep a bottle of[1] something good under the table to be taken out[2] after each lesson[3].

后来，辛格开始在桌子底下放一瓶好东西，每上完一课就拿出来。

VOCABULARY

1 a bottle of 一瓶

2 take out 拿出

3 lesson *n.* 课

The Greek[1] never got on to[2] the erratic[3] movements[4] of the knights[5] and the sweeping[6] mobility[7] of the queens[8], ...

那个希腊人始终没弄懂马那飘忽不定的走法和后那横扫全盘的机动性，

VOCABULARY

1. **Greek** *n.* 希腊人
2. **get on to** 领会；弄明白
3. **erratic** *adj.* 飘忽不定的；不规则的
4. **movement** *n.* 走法；移动
5. **knight** *n.*（国际象棋的）马
6. **sweeping** *adj.* 横扫的；大范围的
7. **mobility** *n.* 机动性；灵活性
8. **queen** *n.*（国际象棋的）后

… but he learned to make a few set[9], opening[10] moves[11].

不过他学会了几步固定的开局走法。

VOCABULARY

9 **set** *adj.* 固定的；既定的

10 **opening** *adj.* 开局的

11 **move** *n.*（棋的）一步；走法

He preferred[1] the white pieces[2] and would not[3] play if the black men[4] were given him.

他更喜欢执白棋，要是把黑子给他，他就不肯下。

VOCABULARY

1. prefer *v.* 更喜欢
2. piece *n.* 棋子
3. would not 不肯；不愿
4. man *n.* （棋类的）棋子

After the first moves[1] Singer worked out[2] the game by himself[3] while his friend looked on[4] drowsily[5].

走完开头几步后，辛格就自己把这盘棋下完，他的朋友则在一旁昏昏欲睡地看着。

VOCABULARY

1. **move** *n.*（棋的）一步
2. **work out** （一步步）推演完；解决
3. **by oneself** 独自
4. **look on** 旁观
5. **drowsily** *adv.* 昏昏欲睡地

If Singer made brilliant[2] attacks on[1] his own men[3] so that[4] in the end[5] the black king[6] was killed, ...

如果辛格对自己的棋子发起精彩的进攻，结果黑王最终被杀，

VOCABULARY

1. make attacks on 对……发起进攻
2. brilliant *adj.* 精彩的；出色的
3. man *n.*（棋类的）棋子
4. so that 结果；以至于
5. in the end 最终
6. king *n.*（国际象棋的）王

… Antonapoulos was always very proud[7] and pleased[8].

安东尼帕罗斯总是非常得意、非常高兴。

VOCABULARY

7 **proud** *adj.* 得意的；自豪的

8 **pleased** *adj.* 高兴的

The two mutes[1] had no other friends, and except[2] when they worked, they were alone[3] together.

两个哑巴没有别的朋友，除了上班的时候，总是只有他们俩待在一起。

VOCABULARY

1. **mute** *n.* 哑巴；哑人
2. **except** *conj.* 除了
3. **alone** *adj.* 单独的；独自的

Each day was very much like[1] any other day, because they were alone[2] so much that[3] nothing ever disturbed[4] them.

每一天都和别的日子十分相像，因为两人独处得太多，从来没有什么事打扰过他们。

VOCABULARY

1. **very much like**
   和……十分相像
2. **alone** *adj.* 单独的；独自的
3. **so...that**
   如此……以至于
4. **disturb** *v.* 打扰；扰乱

Once a week[1] they would go to the library[2] for Singer to withdraw[3] a mystery book[4] and on Friday night they attended[5] a movie[6].

他们每周去一次图书馆，好让辛格借一本推理小说；星期五晚上，他们会去看一场电影。

VOCABULARY

1. once a week 每周一次
2. library *n.* 图书馆
3. withdraw *v.* （从图书馆）借（书）；取出
4. mystery book 推理小说；侦探小说
5. attend *v.* 观看；出席
6. movie *n.* 电影

Then on payday[1] they always went to the ten-cent[2] photograph[3] shop above the Army and Navy Store so that[4] Antonapoulos could have his picture taken[5].

此外，每逢发薪日，他们总要去陆海军商店楼上那家十美分一张的照相馆，好让安东尼帕罗斯拍张照片。

VOCABULARY

1. payday *n.* 发薪日
2. ten-cent *adj.* 十美分的
3. photograph *n.* 照片
4. so that 以便；为了
5. have one's picture taken （请人给自己）拍照

These were the only places where they made customary[2] visits[1].

他们惯常光顾的地方，就只有这几处。

VOCABULARY

1 make a visit
去（某地）；拜访

2 customary *adj.*
惯常的；习惯的

There were many parts in the town that they had never even[1] seen.

镇上有许多地方，他们连见都没见过。

VOCABULARY

1 **even** *adv.* 甚至；连……都

The town was in the middle of[1] the deep South[2].

这个镇子地处南方腹地的中部。

VOCABULARY

1 **in the middle of**
在……的中部

2 **the deep South**
（美国）南方腹地；深南部

The summers were long and the months of winter cold[1] were very few.

这里夏季漫长，冬天寒冷的月份屈指可数。

VOCABULARY

1 cold *n.* 寒冷；冷天

Nearly always the sky was a glassy[1], brilliant[2] azure[3] and the sun burned[4] down riotously[5] bright[6].

天空几乎总是玻璃般明净、灿烂夺目的蔚蓝色，太阳灼灼地照射下来，亮得放肆。

VOCABULARY

1. **glassy** *adj.* 玻璃般透亮的；光滑如镜的
2. **brilliant** *adj.* 灿烂的；明亮的
3. **azure** *n.* 蔚蓝；天蓝色
4. **burn** *v.* （阳光）灼照；炙烤
5. **riotously** *adv.* 放肆地；狂放地
6. **bright** *adv.* 明亮地

Then the light[1], chill[2] rains of November would come, and perhaps[3] later there would be frost[4] and some short months of cold[5].

然后，到了十一月，就会下起清冷的小雨，也许再往后会有霜冻，还有短短几个月的寒冷天气。

VOCABULARY

1. **light** *adj.*（雨）小的；轻的
2. **chill** *adj.* 寒冷的；冷飕飕的
3. **perhaps** *adv.* 也许
4. **frost** *n.* 霜；霜冻
5. **cold** *n.* 寒冷；冷天

The winters were changeable[1], but the summers always were burning hot[2].

这里的冬天变化无常，夏天却总是酷热难当。

VOCABULARY

1 changeable *adj.* 多变的；变化无常的

2 burning hot 灼热的；酷热的

The town was a fairly[1] large one.

这个镇子规模相当大。

VOCABULARY

1 **fairly** *adv.* 相当；颇

On the main street[1] there were several[2] blocks[3] of two- and three-story[4] shops and business offices[5].

大街上有好几个街区都是两三层的商店和商业办公楼。

VOCABULARY

1. **main street** 大街；主街
2. **several** *adj.* 几个
3. **block** *n.* 街区
4. **three-story** *adj.* 三层（楼）的（story：楼层）
5. **business office** 商业办公楼

But the largest buildings[1] in the town were the factories[2], which employed[3] a large percentage of[4] the population[5].

不过，镇上最大的建筑是工厂，这些工厂雇用了全镇很大一部分人口。

VOCABULARY

1. building *n.* 建筑物
2. factory *n.* 工厂
3. employ *v.* 雇用
4. a large percentage of 很大比例的；很大一部分
5. population *n.* 人口

These cotton mills[1] were big and flourishing[2] and most of[3] the workers in the town were very poor.

这些棉纺厂规模庞大、生意兴隆，而镇上的大多数工人都非常贫穷。

VOCABULARY

1 cotton mill 棉纺厂

2 flourishing *adj.* 兴旺的；繁荣的

3 most of 大多数

Often in the faces along the streets there was the desperate[1] look[2] of hunger[3] and of loneliness[4].

街上的一张张面孔，常常流露出饥饿与孤独的绝望神情。

VOCABULARY

1. desperate *adj.* 绝望的
2. look *n.* 神情；样子
3. hunger *n.* 饥饿
4. loneliness *n.* 孤独；寂寞

But the two mutes[1] were not lonely[3] at all[2].

但这两个哑巴一点也不孤独。

VOCABULARY

1. **mute** *n.* 哑巴；哑人
2. **not...at all** 一点也不
3. **lonely** *adj.* 孤独的；寂寞的

At home they were content to[1] eat and drink, and Singer would talk with his hands eagerly[2] to his friend about all that was in his mind[3].

在家里，他们吃吃喝喝就心满意足了；辛格会用双手热切地向朋友诉说心里想的一切。

VOCABULARY

1 **be content to**
满足于（做某事）；乐于

2 **eagerly** *adv.* 热切地；急切地

3 **in one's mind** 在心里

So, the years passed **in this way**[1] until Singer **reached the age of**[2] thirty-two and had been in the town with Antonapoulos for ten years.

就这样，岁月平静地流逝，直到辛格到了三十二岁，已经和安东尼帕罗斯在这个镇上住了十年。

VOCABULARY

1 **in this way** 就这样；以这种方式

2 **reach the age of** 到了……岁